

Is your CA firm ready to scale with AI?

A practical guide for practice owners: see **where your hours really go**, mirror your own workflows, and find the first place an AI agent earns its keep — without touching your running operations.

01 THE DETERMINISTIC CEILING

Every CA firm has spent a decade automating the **calculation**. You already run the calculators:

LEDGER & BOOKS	TallyPrime	Zoho Books	Busy	Marg
GST & RECON	ClearTax	Cygnnet	IRIS GST	Octa GST
TAX · TDS · AUDIT DESK	Winman	KDK / Zen	Saral	Genius
SETTLEMENT	Unicommerce	EasyEcom		

- 1 These tools compute — they don't do the relay around the compute.** They match the clean rows and file the return. The moving of data, the matching of exceptions, the chasing of clients, the waiting on portals — that's still a person.
- 2 Calculation was never the bottleneck.** ClearTax will reconcile 10,000 rows in a minute. It won't chase the vendor whose invoice didn't match, draft the client note, or propose the entry. That leftover is the ceiling.
- 3 And the leftover is where your firm actually spends the month.** Every unmatched row, every 26AS gap, every re-keyed statement lands back on your team — per client, per cycle, per state.

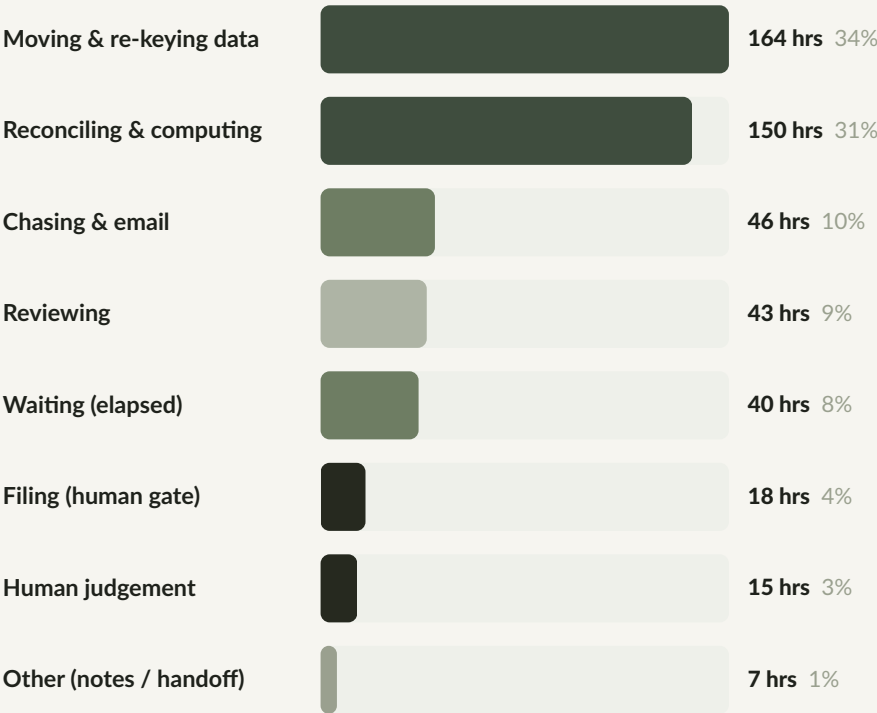
Software calculates and reconciles the clean rows. What it can't — the **exceptions, the re-keying, the chase** — falls to your people. That leftover is exactly what an AI agent now absorbs: **consistently, and with your team approving every step.**

Where does the month actually go? Turn the page. →

Where the hours actually go — and only ~3% is the judgement you sell.

INDICATIVE

A month of compliance effort by activity. Filing is the easy part; the cost is the relay around it.



65%

moving & reconciling data — exactly what an agent absorbs

3%

true judgement — what stays with your people

Filing is the easy part. Two-thirds of the month is moving data and reconciling it — the firm pays it again every cycle, per client, per state. Your judgement (3%) is what should stay.

→ WHAT CLEARING THE RELAY BUYS YOU

2-3× the clients

Same team. Capacity comes from clearing the relay, not from more hires in a tight talent market.

Compliance → advisory

Move senior people off execution and onto the billable, high-margin judgement work.

A reliable system

Consistent, high-accuracy output every cycle — same checks, same audit trail, no busy-season variance.

Before you automate anything, find your hotspots.

Don't start with a tool — start with a map. Walk your last month **stage by stage** and mark where volume, effort and errors actually pile up. Where all three run high, that's where an agent pays first. This is a mirror, not a test — no score, just an honest look at your own workflow.

LIFECYCLE STAGE	WHO OWNS IT TODAY	VOLUME	EFFORT	ERRORS / REWORK
Source docs & capture Invoices, bank statements, bills via email/WhatsApp/portals	Junior accountant	H · M · L	H · M · L	H · M · L
Ingestion & re-keying • hotspot Typed or imported into Tally / books	Junior + accounts exec	H · M · L	H · M · L	H · M · L
Sub-ledger prep AR, AP, fixed assets, inventory, payroll	Accounts exec	H · M · L	H · M · L	H · M · L
Reconciliations • hotspot Bank, vendor, GST 2A/2B, TDS 26AS, marketplace, gateway	Senior / outsourced CA	H · M · L	H · M · L	H · M · L
Classification & coding Map to chart of accounts, cost centre, GST head	Accounts exec → senior	H · M · L	H · M · L	H · M · L
Adjustments & provisions Accruals, prepaid, depreciation, FX, eliminations	Senior / CA	H · M · L	H · M · L	H · M · L
Trial balance & close Tie-out, debits = credits, sign-off	CA / controller	H · M · L	H · M · L	H · M · L

Circle H / M / L in each cell for your firm. Shaded rows are where most firms find their first hotspots — confirm for yours.

Volume
How many items, how often — per client, per cycle, per state.

Effort
Staff hours and the re-keying between systems that never shows on an invoice.

Errors & rework
Mismatches, rejections, notices — and the time spent chasing them down.

Then pressure-test each hotspot through six lenses:

- Exception tail
- Connected tools
- Client-data readiness
- People & skills
- Security & governance
- Service mix

Is the exception handled by a **process** or a **person**? Is data re-keyed between tools? Could you defend it with an audit trail? The stages where volume, effort and errors all run high — those are your first agents, not the whole firm at once.

Move your capacity up the value ladder.

Every CA workstream sits somewhere on volume vs. judgement. Today most of your firm's hours sit bottom-right — high-volume execution. That's exactly what agents absorb, freeing your people to move up-left, to judgement and margin.



The move isn't cutting people — it's **re-deploying** them. Bookkeeping, compliance and accounting are where hours concentrate and margins are thinnest; advisory, consulting, litigation and fundraise/IPO are where judgement — and pricing power — live. Agents absorb the bottom-right execution load; your team climbs toward the work clients actually pay a premium for.

The four things every partner asks.

“Will this replace my staff?”

No — it **retargets** them. Agents take the execution relay; your people move to reviewing agent output and to advisory — the billable work. You expand capacity with the team you already have.

“Will this disrupt my running operations?”

No rip-and-replace. Agents **sit on top of** Tally and your existing ClearTax / Cygnet / portals — reading and writing, not replacing. Start with one workflow, on a few clients.

“Is my clients' data safe? Does the AI train on it?”

Data stays **in India** and is **not used to train anyone's model**. Role-based access means staff see only their clients; everything is encrypted, with an audit trail on every action.

“I already have this software — why an agent?”

Your software **calculates; it doesn't resolve**. It won't chase the mismatch, draft the client note, or propose the entry. That relay is exactly what an agent does — with you approving each step.

→ YOUR FIRST WIN — IN 90 DAYS

1

Pick the worst hotspot

From your mirror — usually TDS 26AS or GSTR-2B ITC gaps across high-volume clients. One workflow, not ten.

2

Run it human-in-the-loop, 30 days

The agent chases, drafts and proposes; your team approves. Track hours saved and exceptions cleared.

3

Expand on evidence

Add the next agent — GST match, vendor ledger, bank rec. Each addition is days, not quarters.

Book a 30-minute working session.

Bring your mirror. We'll map your **three worst hotspots** to specific agents and hand you a **prioritised AI roadmap for your firm** — whether or not you ever work with us.

cal.com/ashish-jadhao-5s0pjh/lekha-ai-product-onboarding

Or reach the founder directly: ashish@scaleupcfo.in



SCAN TO BOOK

SOURCES & NOTES

Activity split on page 2 is an **indicative** illustration of a monthly compliance load, not a sourced statistic. ¹ EY India, "94% of CFOs and tax leaders expect GenAI as a game-changer for tax functions," Nov 2024. ² Tally SMB share 75–80%: Jadhavar BI; Business India. ³ Reconciliation time 60–80% / error ~95% reduction: ResolvePAY (vendor benchmark — directional). ⁴ Indian high-volume AP exception rates 60–75%: Binary Semantics. Tool names are the categories Lekha connects to, not endorsements. Figures are directional, not outcome guarantees.